

slides

July 6, 2026

1 AI Owners Club

2 [OwnersClub.ai](#)

2.1 *Own Your Own AI*

2.1.1 Welcome & Logistics

- **Goal:** Collaborative development and support for owning your own AI.
- **Logistics:** Bring your laptop (if you want to).
- **Overview** of the 2.5-hour agenda
 - First Hour: Getting started with Jan
 - Second Hour: Digging into the technology
 - Final Half Hour: Feedback and planning for the Owners Club

3 What is Jan

3.1 [Jan.ai](#)

3.2 A local-first ChatGPT clone and model hub

3.3 OSS Apache 2 License

3.4 GitHub Repo: <https://github.com/janhq/jan>

3.5 Releases on GitHub: <https://github.com/janhq/jan/releases>

4 OwnersClub hotspot at the Hacker Dojo

4.1 WiFi

4.1.1 SSID: OwnersClub

4.1.2 password: local-first-ai

4.2 Local Site

4.2.1 <http://wiki3.local>

4.2.2 Mirrors for Jan.ai releases and some models

4.3 NOTICE

This hotspot runs a caching web service to optimize model downloading. We try to avoid interfering with other web sites or snooping on you but there is a risk.

There is a certificate if you want to trust it and use SSL but it is not required (or even recommended).

5 Your First Local LLM

5.1 For folks at HD:

5.1.1 Configure the proxy settings

5.2 Download the model from the Jan Hub

5.2.1 Filter, choose, download.

5.3 [Hello World]

5.3.1 Start a new chat, type some simple message and hit enter or click go button

6 Using the exa Search MCP

6.1 <https://exa.ai/mcp>

6.1.1 Free tier: 20,000 searches per month

6.2 Try a message that needs current news like [What’s happening in the World Cup?]

6.2.1 MCP tool search permission dialog

6.2.2

7 Using the local files MCP

- Is this the way to go? It requires NodeJS and not contained, so certainly optional.

8 Using OpenRouter, a cloud LLM service

8.1 What if I need more performance that my machine has?

9 The Philosophy of Owning Your AI

9.0.1 Why Local-First AI?

- Personal AI will make Personal Computers actually personal (again).
- This echoes the 1970s homebrew computer era, when we built our own systems due to a lack of choices.
- Comparing the bespoke nature of Web1 and repersonalization of Web3 to the big tech hegemony of Web2.
- Why open-source software (OSS) and “free as in freedom” are crucial to owning your AI.

10 Understanding the Technology

10.0.1 What is an LLM?

- LLMs are pure functions in software systems which are otherwise pretty much just ordinary applications.
- They solve the incredibly difficult problem of understanding and using human language.

- They are computationally expensive.
- There are wide variations in performance with big factors including size, training data & method, and inference algorithm.

11 Analogies for AI

11.0.1 How do we think about AI?

- **The Electricity Analogy:** Andrew Ng: “[AI is the new electricity](#)”

And we’re not in the 1880s yet, we’re much much closer to the mid/late 1700s (Lyden Jar) and early 1800s (Voltaic Pile).

<https://library.si.edu/exhibition/fantastic-worlds/body-electric>

12 Analogies for AI

- **Car Ownership**
- Owning an AI is like owning a car.
- The CPU & GPU are engine and turbo. An agent harness is a chassis. This can go on for dashboard, windows, body, etc.
- **But an AI isn’t a car**
- It is, or can be, a riding mechanic and tools for modifying the car, and even a car factory too.
<https://connorskelly.substack.com/p/building-plane-while-flying-burnout>

13 Tools and Solutions

13.0.1 Toolset Overview

- **Local Applications:** Jan.ai (Mac, Win, Linux), LMStudio.ai (Mac, Win, Linux), and Osa.ai (Mac).
- **Browser & Server Tools:** WebLLM, Home Assistant, and the Wiki3.ai Web Proxy / IPFS Model Server.

14 Solving the RAG Problem

14.0.1 Adding Document Intelligence to Jan.ai

- **The Problem:** Jan.ai does not support built-in RAG, meaning you can’t drop a folder of PDFs into it to ask questions directly.
- **The Solution:** Layer Jan.ai as a clean, privacy-first UI over Haystack and Open WebUI.
- Haystack indexes documents locally, and Open WebUI provides RAG via an OpenAI-compatible API to connect with Jan.ai, keeping all data on your machine.

15 Hands-On Application

15.0.1 Setup & Configuration

- Walkthrough of Jan.ai installation for Mac and Windows.
- Connecting to models using OpenAI-compatible APIs.
- Utilizing free tiers, such as Groq and OpenRouter, and exploring task-based model routing.

16 Expanding Capabilities

16.0.1 Advanced Integration

- Integrating tools and skills like web search and research.
- Exploring Model Context Protocol (MCP) servers and tools.

17 Workshop Practice & Conclusion

17.0.1 Practice & Problem Solving

- **Workshop / Fix It:** Bring your AI ownership issues and questions, and we'll work on them with you.
- **Member Demos:** Show the group what you did or learned in the class.

18 Community & Feedback

18.0.1 What's Next?

- Gathering feedback on what use cases to cover next and how to improve the class.
- This class is Open Source—we are seeking people to localize, customize, and deliver the class themselves.